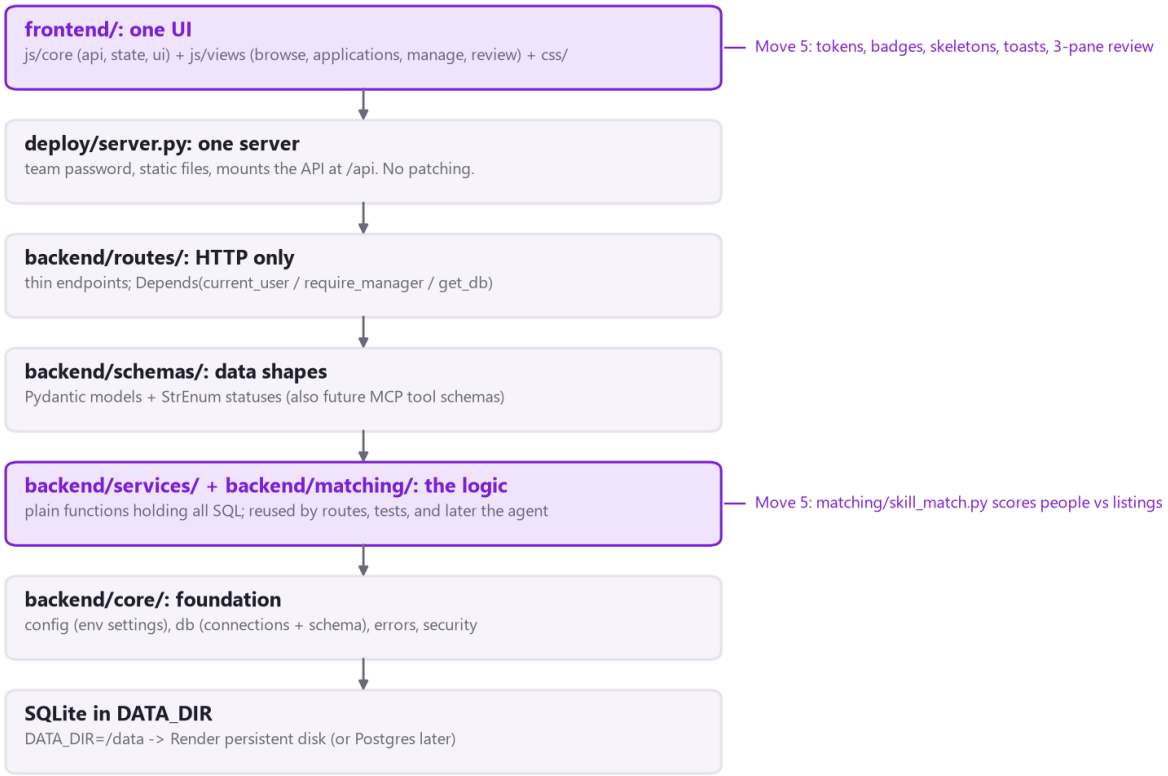
Phase 3 - Move 5: The UI Pass + the Headline Features

Branch: phase3. Folders walked through: frontend/ (css/, js/core/, js/views/) and backend/matching/, plus the matching and profile endpoints. This covers audit Sections 2 (de-vibe-coding the GUI) and 3.1 to 3.3 (skill match, status tracker, live activity feed).

1. In one sentence

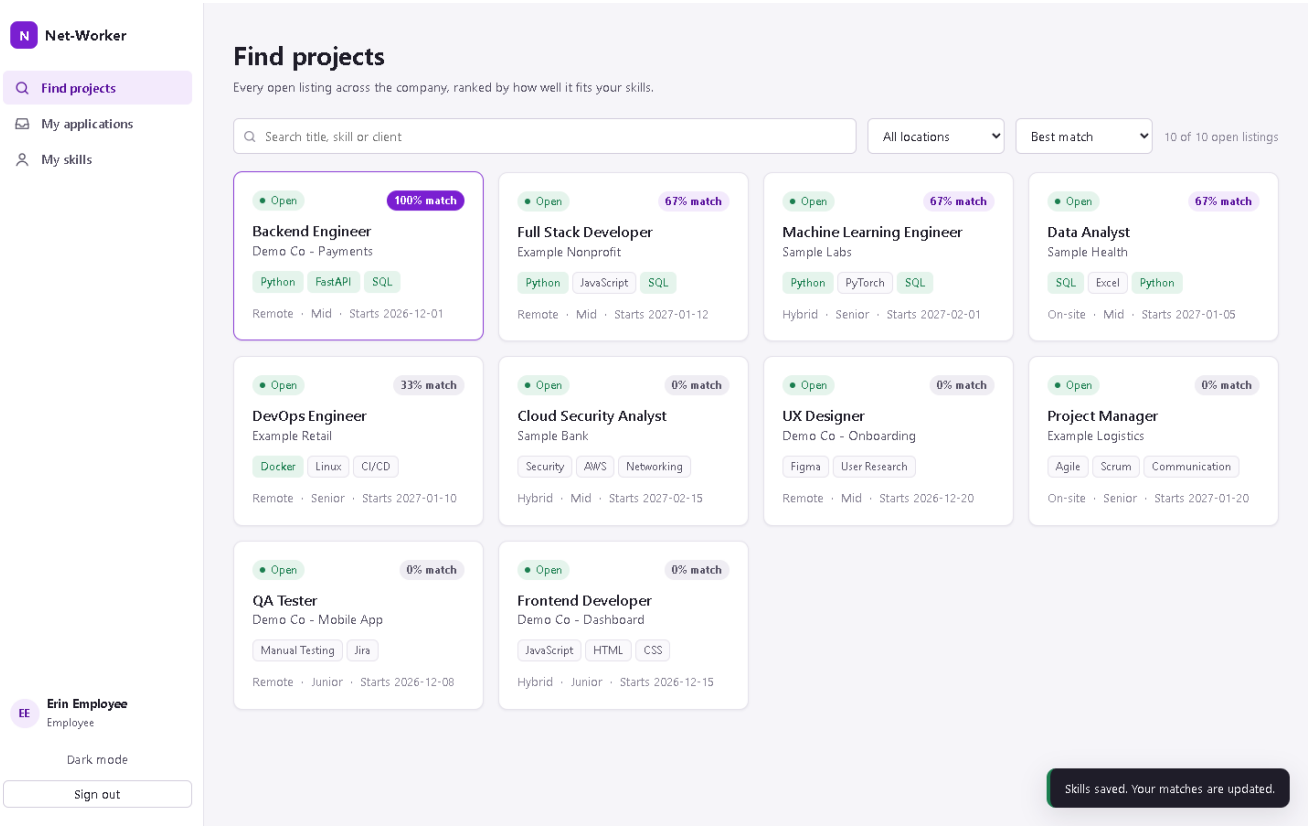
The site now looks like an internal enterprise tool: a Teams-style left rail, flat purple-accented surfaces, one badge system, loading skeletons, toasts, and a 3-pane review screen. It also has three features that demo well: **"% match" on every listing**, a **tracker that updates by itself**, and a **live activity feed**.

Move 5: what changed (purple)

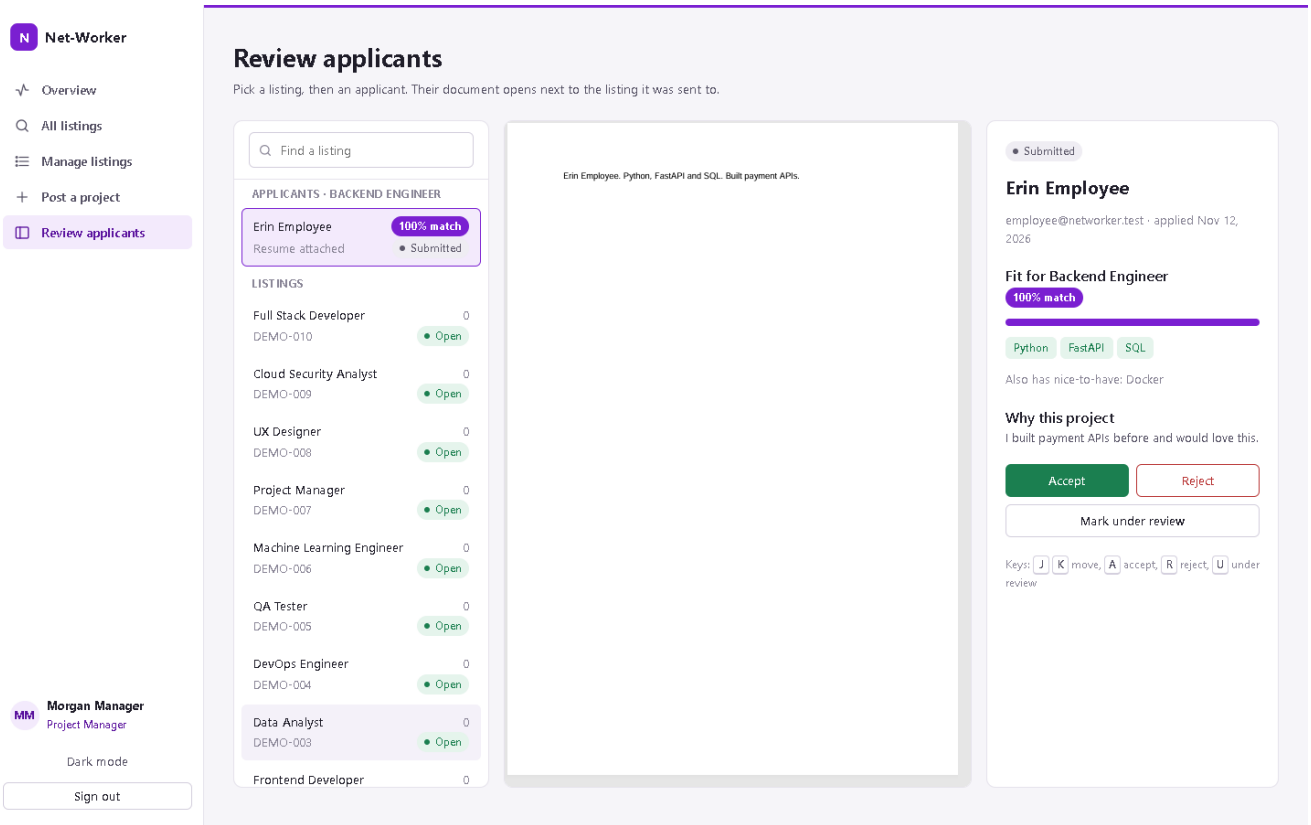


2. What the screens look like now

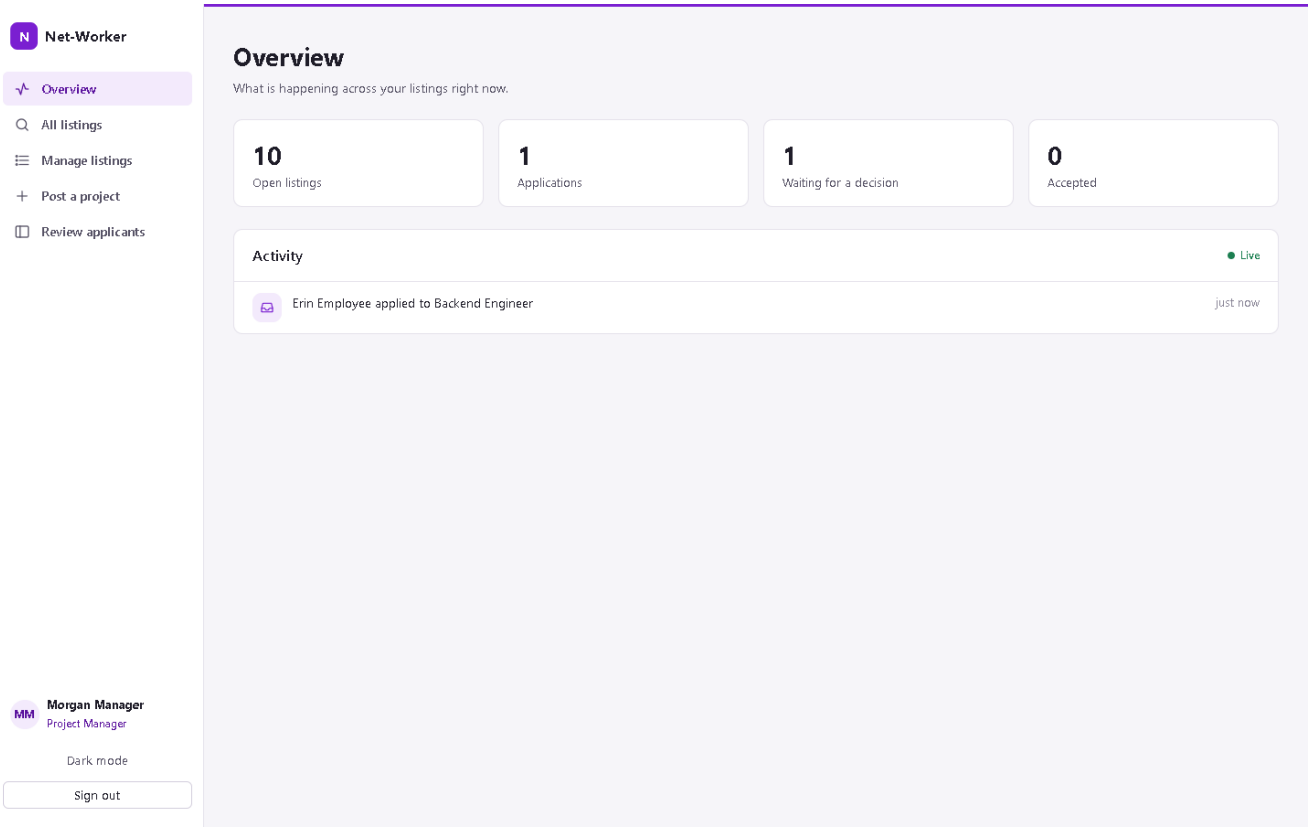
Employee: "Find projects", ranked by fit. Every card shows its % match, and the matching skills turn green.



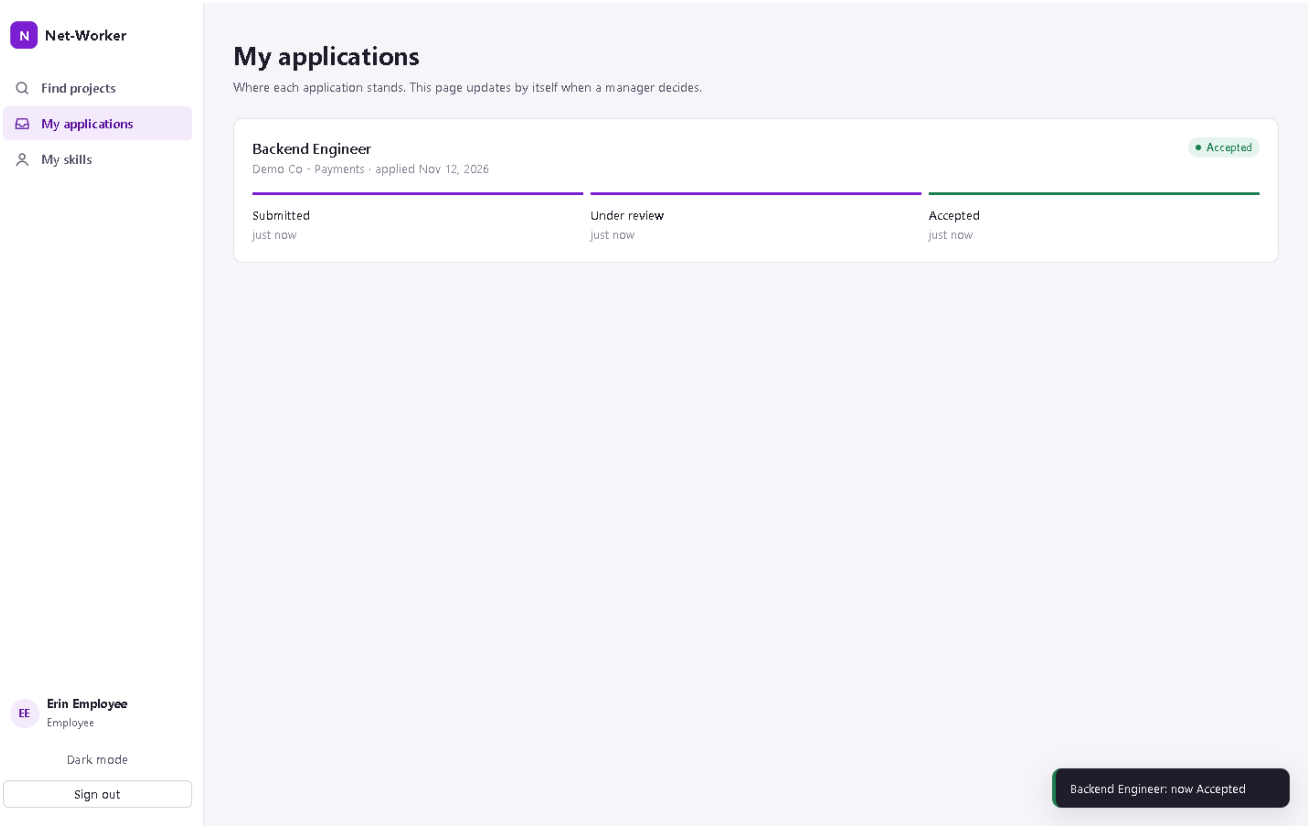
Manager: Review applicants. On the left are the listing and its applicants, ranked by match. The PDF sits in the centre, and the decision panel is on the right.



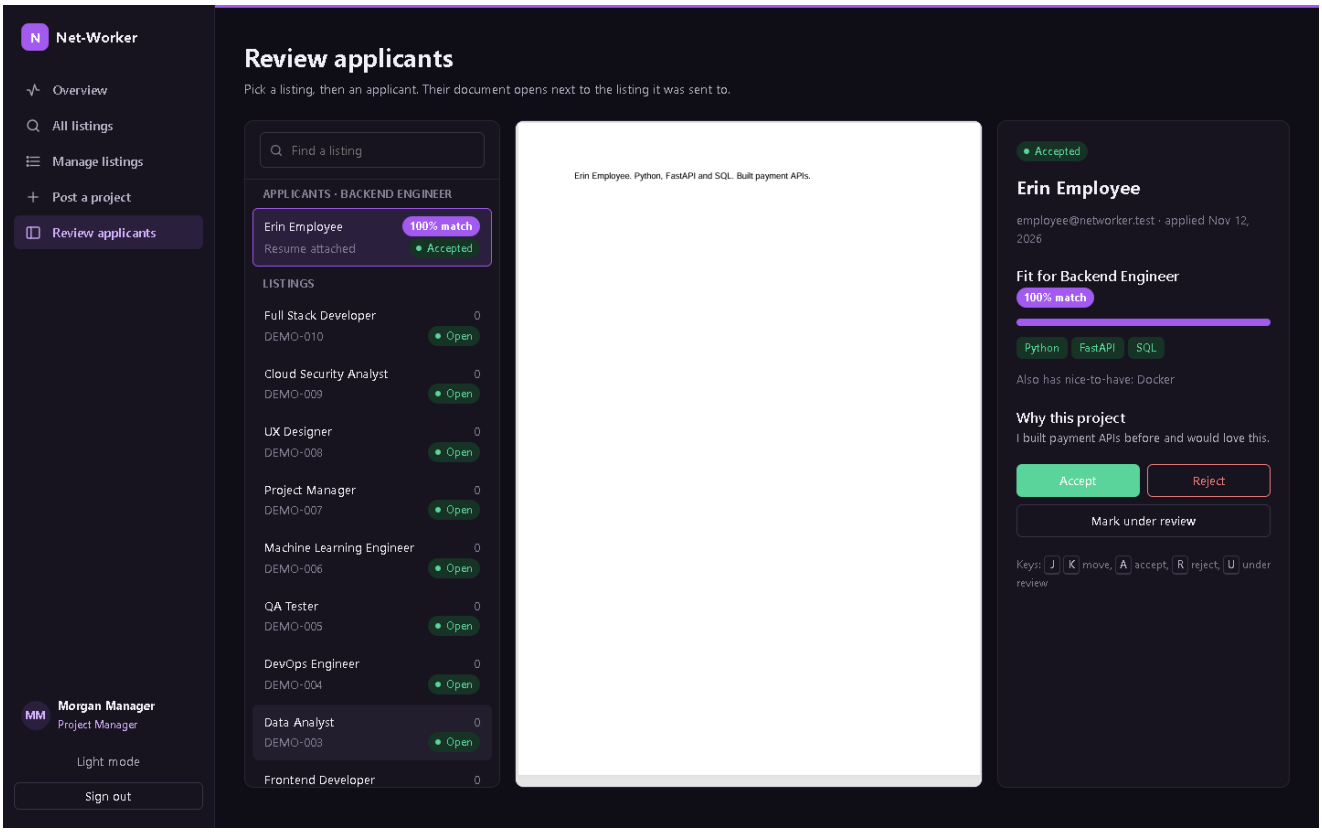
Manager: Overview. Headline numbers, plus the live activity feed.



Employee: My applications. The tracker moved to "Accepted" on its own, with no reload, while the manager clicked Accept in another window.



Dark mode (one click, remembered per browser):



3. Walkthrough: frontend/ (13 files, all under 250 lines)

Folder / file	Lines	Job
index.html	88	The page skeleton: login wall, app shell (rail + main), drawer, toast area
css/tokens.css	97	Every color, size and spacing value. Light theme + dark theme. Nothing else hard-codes a color.
css/base.css	192	Page layout: login wall, the left rail, phone-width layout
css/components.css	229	Buttons, inputs, badges, match pills, chips, cards, skeletons, drawer, toasts, tables
css/views.css	127	Screen layouts: feed toolbar, overview tiles + feed, tracker stepper, 3-pane review
js/core/api.js	45	The one API client: apiFetch / sendJSON / sendForm. 401 sends you to the login wall.
js/core/ui.js	135	Small helpers: badge(), matchPill(), skeletonCards(), emptyState(), toast(), polling, icons, dates
js/core/components.js	190	Shared by both roles: ListingCard, ProjectMetadata, MatchBreakdown, renderJobFeed, Stepper
js/views/employee.js	198	EmployeeDashboard: Find projects, My applications (live), My skills
js/views/manager.js	163	ManagerAdminDashboard: All listings, Manage listings (pipeline), Post a project
js/views/review.js	191	The 3-pane review screen + keyboard shortcuts
js/views/activity.js	80	Manager overview: KPI tiles + the live activity feed
js/app.js	201	Login wall, theme toggle, and the router (#/role/page)

Still vanilla JavaScript: no framework or build step, matching the rest of the repo. Each screen is a plain function that fills a box with HTML.

What changed visually (audit Section 2)

Before	After
Purple radial-gradient background, gradient buttons with glow	Flat surfaces. Purple is used only for primary actions, focus and the active page.
Ten equally loud "Apply" buttons per screen	The whole card opens a details drawer; one primary action inside it
Status as plain text or colored text	One badge system with one color per status, and the word is always shown
"Loading...", empty paragraphs, alert()	Skeleton cards, designed empty states with an action, toasts
Native dropdown to pick a listing; status dropdown	Searchable listing list; Accept / Reject / Under review buttons; keys J K A R U
Top text tabs	Teams-style left rail with icons. Manager mode adds a thin purple line on top of every page.
Dark only	Light by default (better on projectors), dark mode one click away

4. The headline features

4.1 "% match" (backend/matching/skill_match.py, 78 lines, no AI)

The rules are simple enough to explain on a slide:

1. Split the listing's required skills: "Python; FastAPI; SQL".
2. A skill counts if it is in the person's **skills list** or appears as a **whole word in their resume text** (which we already extract from the PDF or DOCX).
3. Score = matched / required, shown as a percentage. Nice-to-have skills are a bonus and never lower the score.

Details a reviewer might poke at, all tested:

- "JS" counts as JavaScript (a small alias list).
- "Java" does **not** match "JavaScript", and "R" does not match inside "React" (whole words).
- "C++" works.
- A listing with no requirements scores 0%, never a fake 100%.

Endpoint	Who	What
GET /api/insights/matches	employee	% match for every Open listing
GET / PUT /api/applications/profile	employee	My skills (creates the profile on first use)
GET /api/projects/{id}/applications	manager	each applicant now carries match: {score, matched, missing, bonus}
GET /api/applications/{id}/document	manager	the viewer gets the same match breakdown
GET /api/projects/manage	manager	per-listing pipeline: new / in review / accepted / rejected counts

4.2 The tracker that updates itself

"My applications" asks the server again every 10 seconds (while the tab is visible) and redraws a 3-step stepper from the **timeline** that Move 4 records. When a status changes between two refreshes, a toast says so: "Backend Engineer: now Accepted".

4.3 The live activity feed

The manager's Overview polls GET /api/insights/activity?after_id=<newest seen> every 5 seconds. New lines slide in highlighted, and the headline numbers refresh when something changes.

One timer at a time. startPolling() in ui.js keeps a single timer. The router stops it on every page change, and it also stops itself if its page is gone.

5. Two real bugs the stress tests caught (and the fixes)

1. **A slow page could draw over a newer one.** If you left a page before its data arrived, the old page finished late and replaced the new page's content. The fix is in route(): every page now draws into its own fresh box, so a late answer lands in a box that is no longer on screen.
2. **"My skills" could erase what you typed.** The form appeared, then the saved skills loaded and overwrote anything typed in the meantime. The fix keeps the form disabled ("Loading your skills...") until the saved value arrives.

Both were invisible when clicking slowly by hand and caught by the automated Edge walkthrough. That is exactly the kind of bug that shows up in a live demo.

6. Tests

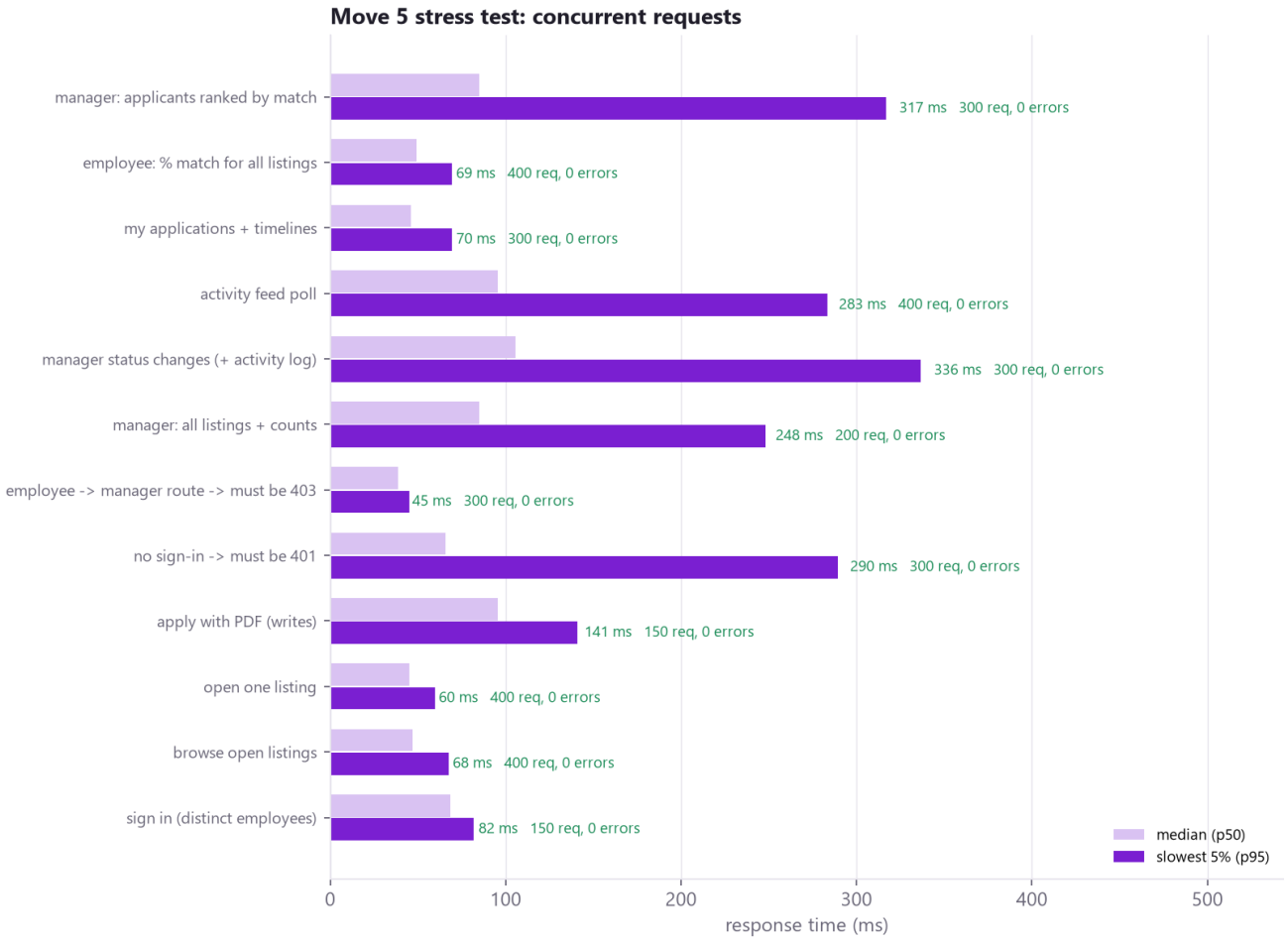
pytest: 65 passed (13 new in tests/features/test_matching.py): splitting rules, 7 scoring cases (aliases, whole words, symbols, resume text, no requirements), bonus skills, profile to matches through the API, resume text counting after applying, managers seeing ranked applicants and pipeline counts, and profile/matches being employee-only.

Edge walkthrough (two windows at once): 16/16 checks, 3 runs in a row

Check	Result
Login wall offers both roles	PASS
Feed shows % match on all 10 cards; best match first (100%)	PASS
Drawer explains the fit (green matched skills)	PASS
Apply with a PDF; tracker shows Submitted	PASS
Manager Overview shows "applied to ..." live	PASS
PDF inline next to the listing; applicant ranked with % match	PASS
Keyboard U = Under Review; Accept saved with a toast	PASS
Employee tracker turns Accepted by itself, no reload	PASS
Stepper reaches all three steps	PASS
Dark mode switches the theme	PASS
Phone width (390 px): no sideways scrolling	PASS
No JavaScript errors in any window	PASS

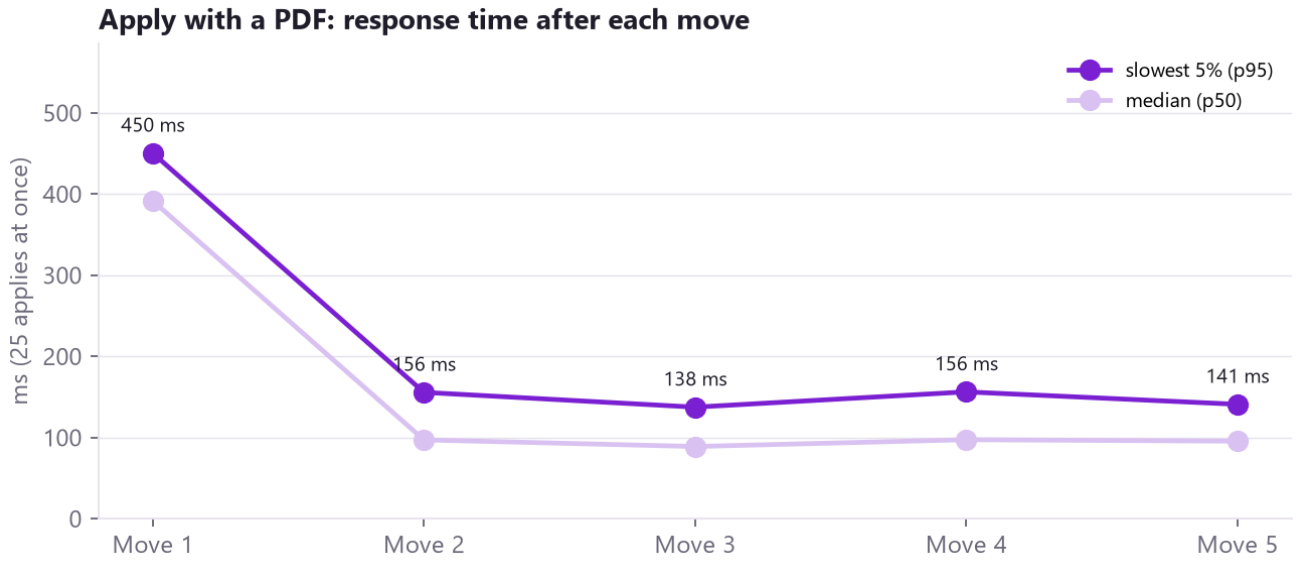
Load: 3,600 requests, 0 errors, including 400 "% match for all listings" (about 70 ms at p95) and 300 ranked

applicant lists.



Honest note on the load test: one run showed 10 "ReadError" failures in a single scenario. The cause was a race in the test tool, not the app. Connections idle for 5 s (uvicorn's default keep-alive) were closed by the server just as the test client reused them. Browsers retry in that case; the test client does not. The load test now runs the server with a 30 s keep-alive, and two repeat runs had 0 errors.

Across all five moves, applying with a PDF went from 450 ms to about 140 ms at p95:



7. Honest notes

- **Matching is keyword-based on purpose.** It is explainable and predictable. A smarter version (synonyms, seniority, embeddings) is a natural first job for the agent, behind the same score() contract.
- **Polling, not websockets.** That is fine for tens of users. For hundreds, server-sent events would be the next step.
- **Only Edge (Chromium) was tested.** Firefox and Safari were not. Hiding the PDF toolbar (#toolbar=0) is a Chromium feature; other browsers simply show their own toolbar.